

INCREDIBLE KARNATAKA

Hidden Gems of Every District

A Comprehensive Travel Documentation

31+ Districts	35+ Hidden Places	GPS Coords Included	7 Regions
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Prepared for: Incredible Karnataka — Official Tourism Website

Verified GPS coordinates • Best season • Access routes • Practical travel tips

Quick Reference — All Hidden Destinations

Hidden Place	District	Category	Best Season	GPS Coordinates
Barid Shahi Tombs (Ashtur)	Bidar	Heritage / Architecture	October – March	<i>17.9241° N, 77.5300° E</i>
Gurmitkal Fort & Step-wells	Yadgir	Heritage / Hidden Fort	November – February	<i>16.8711° N, 77.1849° E</i>
Mudgal Fort	Raichur	Heritage / Fort	October – March	<i>16.0088° N, 76.4438° E</i>
Anegundi Village (Kishkindha)	Koppal	Heritage / Cultural Village	October – February	<i>15.3557° N, 76.5057° E</i>
Lakkundi Temple Complex	Gadag	Heritage / Temple Architecture	Year-round	<i>15.4250° N, 75.9800° E</i>
Hirekerur Trikuteshwara Temple	Haveri	Heritage / Temple	October – March	<i>14.4640° N, 75.3967° E</i>
Bara Kaman — Unfinished Mausoleum	Vijayapura (Bijapur)	Heritage / Architecture	October – March	<i>16.8280° N, 75.7220° E</i>
Almatti Backwaters & Submerged Temples	Bagalkot	Nature / Backwaters	October – January	<i>16.3287° N, 75.8891° E</i>
Daroji Sloth Bear Sanctuary	Ballari (Bellary)	Wildlife / Nature	October – May (dawn & dusk)	<i>15.1780° N, 76.6140° E</i>
Nrupatunga Betta Hilltop	Dharwad	Nature / Viewpoint	October – February	<i>15.4589° N, 75.0078° E</i>
Kittur Fort & Rani Channamma's Palace	Belagavi (Belgaum)	Heritage / History	October – March	<i>15.5753° N, 74.9849° E</i>
Sharana Basaveshwara Math & Caves	Kalaburagi (Gulbarga)	Spiritual / Heritage	October – March	<i>17.3297° N, 76.8343° E</i>
Bandaje Arbi Falls	Dakshina Kannada	Nature / Waterfall	June – November	<i>12.8447° N, 75.5592° E</i>
St. Mary's Island — Hexagonal Basalt Columns	Udupi	Nature / Geology	October – May (ferry season)	<i>13.3737° N, 74.6634° E</i>
Vibhuti Falls, Ganeshgudi	Uttara Kannada	Nature / Waterfall + Wildlife	August – January	<i>15.0523° N, 74.5126° E</i>
Shettihalli Rosary Church — Submerged	Shivamogga (Shimoga)	Heritage / Unusual	Jan–May (fully visible) / Aug–Sep (flooded)	<i>13.5603° N, 75.5947° E</i>
Honnemaradu — Golden Lake	Shivamogga	Adventure / Backwaters	October – March	<i>13.9683° N, 75.1025° E</i>
Kudremukh Peak	Chikkamagaluru	Nature / Trekking	September – January	<i>13.1860° N, 75.2416° E</i>
Mandalpatti Peak — Sea of Clouds	Kodagu (Coorg)	Nature / Viewpoint	October – February	<i>12.3522° N, 75.7319° E</i>
Shravanabelagola — Chandragiri Hill	Hassan	Spiritual / Heritage	Year-round	<i>12.8554° N, 76.4867° E</i>
Melkote — Yoga Narasimha Temple	Mandya	Spiritual / Heritage	October – March	<i>12.8588° N, 76.6482° E</i>
Talakadu — Temples in Sand Dunes	Mysuru	Heritage / Unusual Landscape	October – February	<i>12.1394° N, 77.0420° E</i>
Biligiri Rangaswamy (BRT) Sanctuary	Chamarajanagar	Wildlife / Tribal Heritage	October – May	<i>11.9862° N, 77.1688° E</i>
Savandurga — Asia's Largest Monolith	Ramanagara	Nature / Trekking	October – February	<i>12.9213° N, 77.2916° E</i>
Devarayadurga Forest Hilltop	Tumakuru	Nature / Trekking	October – March	<i>13.3714° N, 77.0207° E</i>
Hutridurga Fort — Obavva's Fort	Bengaluru Rural	Heritage / Trekking	October – March	<i>13.3430° N, 77.0290° E</i>

Hidden Place	District	Category	Best Season	GPS Coordinates
Hesaraghatta Grasslands — Larks' Paradise	Bengaluru Urban	Nature / Birding	November – February	13.1360° N, 77.4780° E
Agumbe — King Cobra Rainforest	Shivamogga (Malnad Edge)	Nature / Rainforest	Jun–Sep (monsoon) / Dec–Feb (post-monsoon)	13.5020° N, 75.0960° E
Kudlu Theertha Falls	Dakshina Kannada	Nature / Waterfall	July – November	12.8333° N, 75.5500° E
Srirangapatna — Daria Daulat Bagh	Mysuru	Heritage / Garden Palace	October – March	12.4166° N, 76.6928° E
Himavad Gopalaswamy Betta	Chamarajanagar	Nature / Spiritual / Wildlife	October – February	11.9292° N, 76.5614° E

NORTH KARNATAKA

■ Barid Shahi Tombs (Ashtur)

District	Bidar	Category	Heritage / Architecture
GPS Coordinates	17.9241° N, 77.5300° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Bidar (5 km)	How to Reach	Auto-rickshaw or drive from Bidar city
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=17.9241,77.5300		
Description	Twelve grand tombs of the Barid Shahi dynasty adorned with Persian-style architecture, mother-of-pearl inlay, and intricate stucco work. Far less visited than Bidar Fort, these tombs sit in a serene garden and rival anything in Bijapur.		

■ Gurmitkal Fort & Step-wells

District	Yadgir	Category	Heritage / Hidden Fort
GPS Coordinates	16.8711° N, 77.1849° E	Best Time to Visit	November – February
Nearest City	Yadgir (30 km)	How to Reach	Local bus to Gurmitkal, then walk
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=16.8711,77.1849		
Description	A completely unguarded medieval fort atop a rocky hill with ancient step-wells (kalyani) that still hold water. Panoramic views of the Deccan plateau in complete solitude — a true time capsule.		

■ Mudgal Fort

District	Raichur	Category	Heritage / Fort
GPS Coordinates	16.0088° N, 76.4438° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Raichur (50 km)	How to Reach	Drive via NH50
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=16.0088,76.4438		
Description	One of Karnataka's most underrated forts, fought over by the Vijayanagara Empire and the Bahmani Sultanate. Massive ramparts, rock-cut cisterns, and mosques inside speak of layered history in total solitude.		

■ Anegundi Village (Kishkindha)

District	Koppal	Category	Heritage / Cultural Village
GPS Coordinates	15.3557° N, 76.5057° E	Best Time to Visit	October – February
Nearest City	Hampi (3 km by coracle)	How to Reach	Coracle ride or jeep via bridge
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=15.3557,76.5057		
Description	Older than Hampi itself and believed to be the mythological Kishkindha from the Ramayana. Ancient temples, banana farms, coracle rides across the Tungabhadra, and a living village atmosphere untouched by mass tourism.		

■ Lakkundi Temple Complex

District	Gadag	Category	Heritage / Temple Architecture
GPS Coordinates	15.4250° N, 75.9800° E	Best Time to Visit	Year-round
Nearest City	Gadag (11 km)	How to Reach	Bus or cab from Gadag
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=15.4250,75.9800		
Description	A cluster of 50+ Chalukyan and Hoysala-era temples dating to the 11th century, featuring exquisitely carved soapstone friezes and stepped tanks. Equal in artistry to Pattadakal but far more peaceful.		

■ Hirekerur Trikuteshwara Temple

District	Haveri	Category	Heritage / Temple
GPS Coordinates	14.4640° N, 75.3967° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Haveri (35 km)	How to Reach	Bus to Hirekerur from Haveri
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=14.4640,75.3967		
Description	A 12th-century triple-shrine Chalukyan temple dedicated to three forms of Shiva. The intricate star-shaped platform and pillar carvings rival Belur and Halebidu but draw almost no visitors.		

■ Bara Kaman — Unfinished Mausoleum

District	Vijayapura (Bijapur)	Category	Heritage / Architecture
GPS Coordinates	16.8280° N, 75.7220° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Bijapur city centre (1 km)	How to Reach	Walk or auto from Gol Gumbaz
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=16.8280,75.7220		
Description	Ali Adil Shah II began this mausoleum intended to dwarf the Taj Mahal and died before completing it. Twelve colossal arches open to the sky, draped in creepers — a hauntingly beautiful monument to ambition and impermanence.		

■ Almatti Backwaters & Submerged Temples

District	Bagalkot	Category	Nature / Backwaters
GPS Coordinates	16.3287° N, 75.8891° E	Best Time to Visit	October – January
Nearest City	Bagalkot (30 km)	How to Reach	Drive to Almatti Dam; local boats available
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=16.3287,75.8891		
Description	The vast backwaters of the Almatti Dam swallowed several ancient villages, creating an ethereal landscape of submerged temple tops visible above the waterline. Boat rides at dusk are among Karnataka's most surreal experiences.		

■ Daroji Sloth Bear Sanctuary

District	Ballari (Bellary)	Category	Wildlife / Nature
GPS Coordinates	15.1780° N, 76.6140° E	Best Time to Visit	October – May (dawn & dusk)
Nearest City	Hampi (15 km)	How to Reach	Cab from Hospet or Hampi
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=15.1780,76.6140		
Description	India's only dedicated sloth bear sanctuary, home to 120+ bears in rocky Deccan habitat. An elevated watch tower guarantees bear sightings at dawn. Practically unknown outside Karnataka.		

■ Nrupatunga Betta Hilltop

District	Dharwad	Category	Nature / Viewpoint
GPS Coordinates	15.4589° N, 75.0078° E	Best Time to Visit	October – February
Nearest City	Dharwad (8 km)	How to Reach	Auto or cab from Dharwad
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=15.4589,75.0078		
Description	A granite boulder-strewn hilltop named after the 9th-century Rashtrakuta poet-king. The summit offers sweeping Deccan panoramas, ancient inscriptions carved on boulders, and sublime sunsets.		

■ Kittur Fort & Rani Channamma's Palace

District	Belagavi (Belgaum)	Category	Heritage / History
GPS Coordinates	15.5753° N, 74.9849° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Belagavi (45 km)	How to Reach	Bus or cab to Kittur village
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=15.5753,74.9849		
Description	The fort from which Rani Channamma led India's first armed rebellion against British rule in 1824 — decades before 1857. A moat-encircled fort with a museum and palace ruins that history books mention but tourists rarely visit.		

KALYANA KARNATAKA

■ Sharana Basaveshwara Math & Caves

District	Kalaburagi (Gulbarga)	Category	Spiritual / Heritage
GPS Coordinates	17.3297° N, 76.8343° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Kalaburagi city (3 km)	How to Reach	Auto / local bus
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=17.3297,76.8343		
Description	Medieval rock-cut caves and a living monastery dedicated to the Veerashaiva saint Sharana Basaveshwara. The 14th-century cave temples carved from a single granite hill contain beautiful lingams and inscription panels unseen in tourism guides.		

COASTAL KARNATAKA

■ Bandaje Arbi Falls

District	Dakshina Kannada	Category	Nature / Waterfall
GPS Coordinates	12.8447° N, 75.5592° E	Best Time to Visit	June – November
Nearest City	Mangaluru (65 km)	How to Reach	Trek from Subramanya or Sakleshpur side
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=12.8447,75.5592		
Description	A spectacular two-tiered waterfall deep in the Western Ghats, requiring a 6 km jungle trek through shola forests and coffee estates. The falls plunge 70 metres into a natural pool — virtually untouched compared to commercialised falls nearby.		

■ St. Mary's Island — Hexagonal Basalt Columns

District	Udupi	Category	Nature / Geology
GPS Coordinates	13.3737° N, 74.6634° E	Best Time to Visit	October – May (ferry season)
Nearest City	Udupi (5 km)	How to Reach	Ferry from Malpe beach
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=13.3737,74.6634		
Description	Four small islands accessible only by boat from Malpe beach, famous for extraordinary hexagonal basalt rock columns formed by ancient volcanic activity — similar to Ireland's Giant's Causeway. A National Geological Monument.		

■ Vibhuti Falls, Ganeshgudi

District	Uttara Kannada	Category	Nature / Waterfall + Wildlife
GPS Coordinates	15.0523° N, 74.5126° E	Best Time to Visit	August – January
Nearest City	Dandeli (28 km)	How to Reach	Cab from Dandeli
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=15.0523,74.5126		
Description	A pristine three-tiered waterfall inside the Dandeli–Anshi Tiger Reserve, surrounded by Malabar pied hornbills and giant squirrels. The trail passes through old-growth forest; the falls feed a deep emerald swimming pool.		

MALNAD REGION

■ Shettihalli Rosary Church — Submerged

District	Shivamogga (Shimoga)	Category	Heritage / Unusual
GPS Coordinates	13.5603° N, 75.5947° E	Best Time to Visit	Jan–May (fully visible) / Aug–Sep (flooded)
Nearest City	Hassan (50 km)	How to Reach	Drive to Shettihalli village
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=13.5603,75.5947		
Description	A 19th-century French Gothic church partially submerged in the Hemavathi reservoir every monsoon and re-emerging in summer like a ghost rising from the water. One of Karnataka's most atmospheric heritage sites — completely free to visit.		

■ Honnemaradu — Golden Lake

District	Shivamogga	Category	Adventure / Backwaters
GPS Coordinates	13.9683° N, 75.1025° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Sagara (12 km)	How to Reach	Drive from Sagara on NH206
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=13.9683,75.1025		
Description	A tiny forest settlement on the Linganamakki Reservoir offering kayaking, coracle rides, and tent stays surrounded by the Western Ghats. At golden hour the still backwaters mirror the forested hills — hence the name Golden Lake.		

■ Kudremukh Peak

District	Chikkamagaluru	Category	Nature / Trekking
GPS Coordinates	13.1860° N, 75.2416° E	Best Time to Visit	September – January
Nearest City	Chikkamagaluru (90 km)	How to Reach	Permit required; drive to Kudremukh village
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=13.1860,75.2416		
Description	Named Horse-face Mountain, Kudremukh rises 1,894 m above sea level and is the source of the Bhadra, Tunga, and Nethravathi rivers. The 22 km trek through rolling shola-grassland meadows crosses one of India's richest biodiversity hotspots.		

■ Mandalpatti Peak — Sea of Clouds

District	Kodagu (Coorg)	Category	Nature / Viewpoint
GPS Coordinates	12.3522° N, 75.7319° E	Best Time to Visit	October – February
Nearest City	Madikeri (30 km)	How to Reach	Jeep from Abbey Falls road, Madikeri
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=12.3522,75.7319		
Description	A pristine grassland plateau 1,748 m above sea level in Pushpagiri Wildlife Sanctuary. Rolling sea-of-clouds views at dawn make this one of Karnataka's most breathtaking sunrise points — only jeeps allowed, access deliberately restricted.		

OLD MYSORE REGION

■ Shravanabelagola — Chandragiri Hill

District	Hassan	Category	Spiritual / Heritage
GPS Coordinates	12.8554° N, 76.4867° E	Best Time to Visit	Year-round
Nearest City	Hassan (50 km)	How to Reach	Bus from Hassan to Shravanabelagola
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=12.8554,76.4867		
Description	While tourists climb Vindhyagiri for the Gomateshwara statue, almost nobody visits the smaller Chandragiri Hill opposite. It holds 7th–12th century Jain temples, royal tombs of Jain kings, and the finest aerial view of the Gomateshwara statue.		

■ Melkote — Yoga Narasimha Temple

District	Mandya	Category	Spiritual / Heritage
GPS Coordinates	12.8588° N, 76.6482° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Mysuru (65 km)	How to Reach	Bus to Melkote, hike up the hill
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=12.8588,76.6482		
Description	A hilltop shrine above the famous Melkote temple town housing an ancient Yoga Narasimha idol behind a carved stone doorway. The climb through wild boulders rewards with panoramic views across the Mysuru plateau.		

■ Talakadu — Temples in Sand Dunes

District	Mysuru	Category	Heritage / Unusual Landscape
GPS Coordinates	12.1394° N, 77.0420° E	Best Time to Visit	October – February
Nearest City	Mysuru (50 km)	How to Reach	Drive via Kollegal Road
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=12.1394,77.0420		
Description	Five ancient Shiva temples swallowed by drifting sand dunes beside the Cauvery river — some still half-buried. Inland sand dunes on a riverbank are extraordinarily rare in peninsular India.		

■ Biligiri Rangaswamy (BRT) Sanctuary

District	Chamarajanagar	Category	Wildlife / Tribal Heritage
GPS Coordinates	11.9862° N, 77.1688° E	Best Time to Visit	October – May
Nearest City	Mysuru (100 km)	How to Reach	Drive via Yelandur
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=11.9862,77.1688		
Description	The unique ecological bridge connecting the Western and Eastern Ghats, BRT is home to the Soliga indigenous community and boasts one of India's highest tiger densities. Mostly uncrowded with excellent leopard and elephant sightings.		

BENGALURU REGION

■ Savandurga — Asia's Largest Monolith

District	Ramanagara	Category	Nature / Trekking
GPS Coordinates	12.9213° N, 77.2916° E	Best Time to Visit	October – February
Nearest City	Bengaluru (60 km)	How to Reach	Drive via Magadi Road
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=12.9213,77.2916		
Description	One of Asia's largest monolith rock formations, Savandurga's twin peaks rise 1,226 m above sea level. A rock-climbing and trekking haven 60 km from Bengaluru with ancient temples at the base and sweeping Deccan views from the summit.		

■ Devarayadurga Forest Hilltop

District	Tumakuru	Category	Nature / Trekking
GPS Coordinates	13.3714° N, 77.0207° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Tumakuru (15 km)	How to Reach	Bus or cab from Tumakuru city
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=13.3714,77.0207		
Description	A thickly forested rocky hill with ancient Bhoga Narasimha and Yoga Narasimha temples atop twin peaks. The surrounding deciduous forest shelters leopards and rare birds — far less visited than Nandi Hills but equally rewarding.		

■ Hutridurga Fort — Obavva's Fort

District	Bengaluru Rural	Category	Heritage / Trekking
GPS Coordinates	13.3430° N, 77.0290° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Tumakuru (15 km)	How to Reach	Bus towards Chitradurga, then local bus
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=13.3430,77.0290		
Description	A 16th-century hill fort famous for Obavva, a woman who single-handedly defended the fort against Hyder Ali's army using a pestle. The steep climb passes through seven gateways, ending with 360-degree Deccan views.		

■ Hesaraghatta Grasslands — Larks' Paradise

District	Bengaluru Urban	Category	Nature / Birding
GPS Coordinates	13.1360° N, 77.4780° E	Best Time to Visit	November – February
Nearest City	Bengaluru (35 km)	How to Reach	Drive via Hesaraghatta Road
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=13.1360,77.4780		
Description	A rare semi-arid grassland on the city's outskirts, one of South India's few places to spot three lark species together, along with Indian Coursers and Painted Sandgrouse. A world-class birding escape within Bengaluru's reach.		

SOUTH KARNATAKA

■ Agumbe — King Cobra Rainforest

District	Shivamogga (Malnad Edge)	Category	Nature / Rainforest
GPS Coordinates	13.5020° N, 75.0960° E	Best Time to Visit	Jun–Sep (monsoon) / Dec–Feb (post-monsoon)
Nearest City	Udupi (50 km) / Shivamogga (90 km)	How to Reach	Drive via NH169
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=13.5020,75.0960		
Description	The Cherrapunji of the South and India's last stronghold of the King Cobra, receiving 7,000+ mm of rain annually. The Rainforest Research Station offers guided night treks to spot king cobras, Malabar gliding frogs, and bioluminescent fungi.		

■ Kudlu Theertha Falls

District	Dakshina Kannada	Category	Nature / Waterfall
GPS Coordinates	12.8333° N, 75.5500° E	Best Time to Visit	July – November
Nearest City	Mangaluru (50 km)	How to Reach	Drive towards Sakleshpur; trail from Kukke Subramanya road
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=12.8333,75.5500		
Description	A majestic 50-metre plunge waterfall in the Western Ghats foothills, reachable only by a 2 km trail through coffee and cardamom plantations. Crystalline mountain water in a perfectly secluded pool.		

■ Srirangapatna — Daria Daulat Bagh

District	Mysuru	Category	Heritage / Garden Palace
GPS Coordinates	12.4166° N, 76.6928° E	Best Time to Visit	October – March
Nearest City	Mysuru (15 km)	How to Reach	Bus or cab from Mysuru
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=12.4166,76.6928		
Description	Tipu Sultan's summer palace built in 1784 on a Cauvery island fortress. Every inch of interior walls is covered in vivid teak-framed murals depicting the Battle of Pollilur. The lush garden and riverside setting make it one of Karnataka's finest gems.		

■ Himavad Gopalaswamy Betta

District	Chamarajanagar	Category	Nature / Spiritual / Wildlife
GPS Coordinates	11.9292° N, 76.5614° E	Best Time to Visit	October – February
Nearest City	Mysuru (90 km)	How to Reach	Drive through Bandipur; forest road open in daylight only
Google Maps	maps.google.com/?q=11.9292,76.5614		
Description	A mist-covered hilltop temple at 1,454 m inside Bandipur Tiger Reserve, where wild elephants and bison are routinely spotted along the forest road. Cloud formations roll in even on clear days, creating an otherworldly atmosphere.		

TRAVEL TIPS & GUIDELINES

Permits & Permissions	Wildlife sanctuaries including Kudremukh, BRT, and Nagarhole's Antharasante gate require Forest Department entry permits. Apply online at karnatakaforest.gov.in or purchase at the gate early morning.
Monsoon Access	Waterfalls (Bandaje Arbi, Vibhuti, Kudlu Theertha) are best September–November — paths passable, falls at peak flow. June–August trails may be closed for safety.
Local Guides	For Anegundi, Daroji Sanctuary, and Agumbe night treks, local guides dramatically improve the experience and support community livelihoods. Contact forest offices or local eco-tourism committees.
Best Photography	Heritage sites like Shettihalli Church, Bara Kaman, and Lakkundi Temples are free to enter with no photography restrictions. Best light: one hour after sunrise.
Accommodation	Most hidden sites have no premium stays nearby. Prepare for homestays (Coorg, Chikkamagaluru, Uttara Kannada), forest lodges (Nagarhole, BRT, Dandeli), or budget hotels in the nearest town.
Mobile Connectivity	Network coverage is patchy in deep forest and Deccan plateau areas. Download offline Google Maps for Bidar, Yadgir, Raichur, and Gadag districts before travelling.
Responsible Tourism	These sites remain pristine precisely because they are fragile. Carry all waste out, do not disturb wildlife, obtain required permits, and avoid single-use plastics in ecologically sensitive zones.
Seasonal Overview	October–February: ideal for all heritage, wildlife, and viewpoints. June–September: best for waterfalls and rainforests. December–January: peak for migratory birds at Hesaraghatta and Unkal Lake.

— Welcome to Karnataka

"One Janma is not enough to explore Karnataka."